the same year, another suspected Jaish-e-Mohammed strike on the Indian army camp at Uri, killing 17 Indian servicemen, led to retaliation in the form of “surgical strikes” by India in territory under Pakistan’s control. In the wake of this, China and Pakistan’s “all-weather friendship” became centre stage in India. A series of Chinese moves had, over time, strengthened the Indian perception of strong Chinese support for a Pakistan set on harming India. China’s practice of issuing stapled visas, rather than regular stamped visas, to Indian citizens of Jammu and Kashmir (J&K), as well as to citizens of Arunachal Pradesh, has created discontent, as the practice indicates that China does not formally recognise India’s sovereignty. In 2010, China denied a visa to Indian Army General B. S. Jaswal, head of the Northern Command based in J&K. In 2015, China supported Pakistan at the UN in the matter of Zakiur Rehman Lakhvi, a leader of Lashkar-e-Taiba and central figure in the 2008 Mumbai terrorist attack. The timing of the support soured Sino–Indian relations, as it followed on the heels of Modi’s visit to Beijing. Likewise, when President Obama visited India in January 2015, Pakistan’s Chief of Army Staff General Sharif visited China, prompting China to state that Pakistan was China’s irreplaceable all-weather friend, the countries being “part of a shared destiny.”[59] Modi eventually focused part of his August 2016 Independence Day speech on Pakistan, drawing attention to conditions in Baluchistan. He followed up on earlier characterisations of Pakistan’s “atrocities” against the people of Baluchistan and Pakistan-occupied-Kashmir (PoK), asserting that Pakistan “bombs its own citizens using fighter planes.”[60] Reactions from Islamabad were strong.

As both the Pathankot and Uri attacks were blamed on the Pakistan-based terrorist organisation Jaish-e-Mohammed, the Chinese strategy of support for Pakistan that most frustrates India is efforts to stall the listing of Jaish-e-